

doc-total-depravity

Affirms · Hamartiology › Depravity · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Sin has corrupted every faculty of fallen man (mind, will, affections, body) such that no part is untouched and unaided man cannot save himself or initiate saving faith.

Rationale

The neutralized proposition (are all faculties of fallen humanity affected by sin) is pan-canonically demonstrated. Rom 3:10-18, citing a catena of Psalms, layers universal negations: *ouk estin dikaios* G1342 *oude heis* G1520 (Rom 3:10), then the throat (larynx G2995) is a *taphos* G5028 *aneōgmenos* (open grave), the *glōssa* G1100 deceives (*edoliousan* G1387), and *ios* G2447 *aspidōn* G785 (venom of asps) is under the lips. The catalogue moves through throat, tongue, lips, mouth (v.14), feet (v.15), eyes (v.18): a body-wide indictment. Rom 8:7 negates *dynamai* G1410 of the *phronēma* G5427 *tēs sarkos* G4561: 'is not even able to submit to God's law'. Eph 2:1 calls the natural state *nekros* G3498 (dead, a corpse) *en tois paraptōmasin* G3900 *kai tais hamartiais* G266. Eph 4:17-19 catalogues the mind under *mataiotēs* G3153, the understanding (*dianoia*) *eskotōmenoi* G4656 (darkened), the person *apēllotriōmenoi* G526 (alienated from God's life) through *agnoia* G52 and *pōrōsis* G4457 (callous hardening). Jer 17:9 says the *leb* H3820 is *aqob* H6121 (deceitful, crooked) above all things and *anush* H605 (incurable, desperately sick). Gen 6:5 says every *yetzer* H3336 of the *machashebot* H4284 of the *leb* was *raq* H7535 *ra* H7451 *kol* H3605 *hayyom* H3117 ('only evil all the day'). Gen 8:21 reaffirms post-flood that the *yetzer* of the heart of man is *ra minneurav* H5271 ('evil from his youth'). Isa 64:6 declares all *tzidqot* H6666 (righteousnesses) like *beged* H899 *iddim* H5708 (a polluted garment). John 3:6 reinforces: what is born *ek tēs sarkos sarx* *estin*, what is born *ek tou pneumatōs pneuma* *estin*: natural birth produces only flesh-life. The convergence is canonical: intellect (Eph 4:18, Rom 1:21), will (John 8:34, Rom 6:17, Rom 8:7), affections (Jer 17:9, Gen 6:5), and body (Rom 3:13-18) are each named under sin. The bare proposition that every faculty is affected and that unaided man cannot of himself produce saving good is canonically demonstrated.

Reasoning

Verdict: every part of fallen human nature has been touched by sin, and on their own, apart from God's grace, fallen humans cannot produce the kind of good that pleases God or come to him in saving faith. This is not a claim that humans are as bad as they could possibly be. It is a claim that no faculty escapes corruption. The strongest reason from Scripture is the way the Bible takes inventory of the human person under sin. In Romans 3:10 to 18, Paul collects passages from the Psalms and Isaiah and lists body parts: throat, tongue, lips, mouth, feet, eyes. He calls the throat an open grave, says the venom of asps is under the lips, and says there is no fear of God before the eyes. It is a head-to-toe indictment. In Ephesians 4:17 to 19, Paul names the mind as futile, the understanding as darkened, the person as alienated from God, with a heart grown hard and callous. In Jeremiah 17:9, the heart is called deceitful above all things and incurable. In Genesis 6:5, every intention of the thoughts of the heart was only evil continually. In Genesis 8:21, after the flood, God says the same thing again: the intention of man's heart is evil from his youth. In Isaiah 64:6, even the best deeds of fallen humans are described as a polluted garment. In Romans 8:7 to 8, the mind set on the flesh is hostile to God, does not submit to his law, and is not able to. In Ephesians 2:1, people apart from Christ are called dead in trespasses. The strongest counterargument from Scripture is the set of passages where God commands all people to repent, where Jesus invites everyone to come, and where Scripture says humans are still made in God's image even after the fall. Genesis 9:6 forbids murder because man is made in God's image, after the flood. Acts 17:30 says God commands all people

everywhere to repent. Critics ask: why command repentance if humans cannot respond, and how can the divine image survive if every faculty is utterly destroyed. The verdict handles this tension by distinguishing two things. First, the image of God is damaged and darkened but not erased; humans remain image-bearers, which is why every human life still has dignity. Second, the inability of fallen man is moral, not physical: people cannot come to God because they will not, because their hearts are hostile, and the command to repent does not measure what they can do but what they owe. Grace is what changes the heart so that the bound will becomes free.

Denominational landscape

Major Christian traditions broadly agree that sin has corrupted every part of human nature and that fallen humans need divine grace to be saved. They disagree on how far the corruption goes and on how grace operates. The Western patristic line was decisive. Augustine, in his Anti-Pelagian writings, defended the doctrine that the will after the fall is bound and cannot do spiritual good without grace. The Council of Carthage in AD 418 condemned Pelagius, who taught that humans can come to God by unaided natural will. The Second Council of Orange in AD 529 condemned semi-Pelagianism, which taught that humans can take the first step toward God on their own. The Catholic Catechism (paragraphs 405 to 407) teaches that original sin wounded human nature, leaving it subject to ignorance, suffering, death, and inclined to evil, but it explicitly rejects the Protestant Reformed claim that the fall destroys human freedom entirely. The Lutheran Book of Concord (Augsburg II and XVIII, Formula of Concord I and II, Luther's Bondage of the Will) affirms that the human will has no power to work the righteousness of God without the Holy Spirit and that fallen man is spiritually dead. The Anglican 39 Articles (Article 9 on original sin and Article 10 on free will) confess that man is very far gone from original righteousness and is of his own nature inclined to evil, and that we have no power to do good works without the grace of God preventing us. The Reformed confessions (Canons of Dort 3/4.1 to 4, Westminster Confession 6.4 and 9.3, Belgic 14, Heidelberg Q8) teach total depravity and total inability: fallen man is wholly incapable of any saving good without regenerating grace, and that grace is effectual. The Methodist Articles of Religion (Article VII on original sin and Article VIII on free will) follow the Anglican wording but are paired with the Wesleyan doctrine of prevenient grace given to all, which partially restores the ability to respond to or resist the gospel. The Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths affirms that the fall left man helpless and that salvation is only through Christ. Eastern Orthodoxy (as represented by the Orthodox Church in America) rejects total depravity in the Augustinian and Reformed sense, teaching that the image of God in man, though darkened, is not erased, and that salvation involves synergism between divine grace and human freedom; original sin transmits consequences (mortality, weakness) not inherited guilt. The clear cult-marker line is Pelagianism, which denies the fall and was condemned in the fifth century. Modern public-record carriers of full denial include Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy taught that sin and the fall are illusions of mortal mind), various New Age teachings, and modern secular humanism. The in-house Christian disagreement on the precise scope of depravity (Reformed total inability versus Catholic and Orthodox wounded-not-destroyed versus Wesleyan prevenient-grace-restored response) is real and irreducible. All historic Christian traditions affirm the underlying claim that fallen humans need divine grace; the precise mechanism is contested.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	No

Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

The doctrine that every faculty of fallen humanity is affected by sin and that unaided man cannot save himself is canonically demonstrated. The cult-marker-if-denied bar is set at false because the precise Reformed scope (the T of TULIP: total inability AND inherited Adamic guilt AND no remaining capacity for any spiritual good apart from regenerating grace) is in-house Christian disagreement. The Reformed-monergetic carriers (Canons of Dort 3/4.1-4, Westminster Confession 6.4 and 9.3, Heidelberg Q8, Belgic 14) affirm total inability and effectual regenerating grace as the only remedy. Lutheran (Augsburg II and XVIII, Formula of Concord I and II, Luther's Bondage of the Will) affirms equally strong language about the bound will and spiritual deadness. Anglican (39 Articles 9 and 10) likewise affirms that man is very far gone from original righteousness and is of his own nature inclined to evil, and that we have no power to do good works without the grace of God preventing us. The Augustinian-Western patristic line (Augustine's Anti-Pelagian writings, Council of Carthage 418 condemning Pelagius, Second Council of Orange 529 condemning semi-Pelagianism) sets the Western consensus. Methodist Articles VII and VIII follow the Anglican wording but pair it with the Wesleyan doctrine of prevenient grace given to all, which restores enough ability for free response to or resistance of the gospel. Pentecostal-Arminian (Assemblies of God) similarly affirms full corruption but holds that prevenient grace restores response capacity. The Catholic Catechism (CCC 405-407) affirms that human nature is wounded, subject to ignorance and inclined to evil, but rejects the Protestant Reformed claim that the fall destroys human freedom entirely. The Eastern Orthodox position (Orthodox Church in America) rejects total depravity in the Augustinian-Reformed sense, teaching that the image of God in man, though darkened, is not erased, and that salvation involves synergism between divine grace and human freedom; original sin transmits consequences (mortality, weakness) rather than inherited guilt. The clear cult-marker line is Pelagianism, which denies the fall and teaches that humans can come to God by unaided natural will; modern carriers include Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy taught that sin and the fall are illusions of mortal mind), various New Age teachings that deny sin altogether, and certain liberal-mainline reductions. But denial of the specific Reformed TULIP scope, while affirming the broader proposition that fallen humans need divine grace, is held by Eastern Orthodoxy, Catholicism (with qualification), Methodism, and Pentecostalism. That irreducible in-house disagreement is why `cult_marker_if_denied=false` honestly. The Brethren formation reads this question through a broadly Reformed lens of total inability without the formal label of TULIP.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Are all faculties of fallen humanity (intellect, will, affections, body) affected by sin, and can fallen humans of themselves produce saving good apart from divine grace?

Notes. The statement uses Reformed-confessional vocabulary as if neutral. The phrase 'every faculty of fallen man (mind, will, affections, body) such that no part is untouched' is a direct paraphrase of the Westminster Confession 6.4 and Canons of Dort 3/4.1-4. The label 'total depravity' is the T of TULIP. The neutralized form drops the confessional vocabulary and asks the bare lexical question. Working the neutralized form, the verdict affirms canonically: Rom 3:10-18 catalogues throat, tongue, lips, mouth, feet, eyes (a body-wide indictment); Eph 4:17-19 indicts mind (mataiotēs), understanding (skotos), affections (callous, alienated); Jer 17:9 indicts the heart (deceitful and incurable); Gen 6:5 indicts the yetzer (intention, inclination) as 'only evil continually'. The four-faculty claim is read out of the lexical pattern, not produced by the confessional label. The Reformed-specific tightening (denial of any remaining cooperative freedom under prevenient grace) is in-house disagreement, not the bare proposition.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology, progressive_covenantalism

analogia scripturae invoked

Competing lens verdicts

Reformed-monergetic (TULIP) · Total depravity in the technical sense: every faculty is comprehensively corrupted, fallen man is incapable of any saving good, regenerating grace is the necessary and effectual cause of saving faith. Rom 3:10-18 plus Eph 2:1-5 plus John 6:44 plus Rom 8:7-8 form the central catena. Canons of Dort 3/4.1-4, Westminster 6.4 and 9.3, Heidelberg Q8, Belgic 14.:

Lutheran-bondage-of-will · Fallen man is spiritually dead and the will has no power to work the righteousness of God without the Holy Spirit. Affirms the comprehensive corruption proposition with language fully as strong as Reformed; differs on sacramental and Christological frames, not on the depravity proposition itself. Augsburg II, Formula of Concord I and II, Luther's Bondage of the Will.:

Anglican-Methodist · Original sin is the corruption of nature; we have no power of ourselves to do good works pleasing to God without prior grace (39 Articles 9-10, Methodist VII-VIII). Methodist position pairs this with the Wesleyan doctrine of prevenient grace given to all, which restores enough capacity for free response. The bare proposition is affirmed; the mechanism of grace differs.:

Catholic-CCC-405-407 · Human nature is wounded by original sin, subject to ignorance, suffering, death, and inclined to evil, but explicitly rejects the Protestant claim that the fall destroys human freedom entirely. The wounded-not-destroyed framework affirms comprehensive corruption while preserving cooperative grace categories.:

Eastern-Orthodox-synergism · Rejects total depravity in the Augustinian-Reformed sense. The image of God in man, though darkened, is not erased; original sin transmits consequences (mortality, weakness) rather than inherited guilt; salvation involves synergism between divine grace and human freedom. Affirms the need for grace; denies the Reformed scope of total inability.:

Pelagian (heretical, condemned) · Denies the fall and its consequences for human nature; teaches that humans can come to God by unaided natural will. Condemned at Carthage 418 and Orange 529. Modern carriers: Christian Science, certain liberal-mainline reductions, secular humanism. This is the cult-marker boundary on the question, not the in-house disagreements above.:

Five historic Christian lenses affirm the bare proposition (every faculty affected, fallen humans need grace) with varying scope. The Reformed-TULIP scope (total inability and irresistible regenerating grace alone) is in-house contested by Catholic, Eastern Orthodox, Methodist, and Pentecostal lineages, which all hold the doctrine in some form while denying its maximally Reformed expression. Pelagianism is the historic cult-marker line. The lexical pattern from Rom 3:10-18, Eph 4:17-19, Jer 17:9, Gen 6:5, Gen 8:21, and Isa 64:6 is unambiguous on the four-faculty proposition; the precise scope of resulting inability is the contested in-house question.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Rom.3.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὐκ ἔστιν δίκαιος οὐδὲ εἷς; dikaios G1342; oude G3761; heis G1520; ouk estin universal-negation construction

Force. 'There is none righteous, no, not even one.' Paul opens his catena from the Psalms with absolute negation. Dikaios (righteous, just) is denied with the categorical oude heis ('not even one'). The construction makes no exception for any human under sin. Verses 9 and 19 frame the catena as applying both to Jew and Gentile, the whole world under sin

Rom.3.13 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. τάφος ἀνεωγμένος ὁ λάρυγξ αὐτῶν ταῖς γλώσσαις αὐτῶν ἐδολιοῦσαν ἰὸς ἀσπίδων ὑπὸ τὰ χεῖλη αὐτῶν; taphos G5028; larynx G2995; glōssa G1100; dolioō G1387; ios G2447; aspis G785

Force. 'Their throat is an open grave, with their tongues they have used deceit, the venom of asps is under their lips.' The taphos aneōgmenos image is a sensory indictment (a grave gives off the stench of decay); the tongues use dolioō (cognate of dolos, deceit, treachery) in imperfect tense (continuous past action). The ios aspidōn (venom of asps, the hooded cobra) places lethal poison on the lips. Three body parts (throat, tongue, lips) are catalogued. Verses 14-18 add mouth, feet, and eyes, completing a head-to-toe indictment

Rom.3.18 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metonymy

Key term. οὐκ ἔστιν φόβος θεοῦ ἀπέναντι τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν αὐτῶν; phobos G5401; ophthalmos G3788

Force. 'There is no fear of God before their eyes.' Closes the catena with the ophthalmoi (eyes) and the absent phobos theou (fear of God). The eyes, often metonymic for moral perception and disposition, are categorically void of the reverence Scripture treats as the beginning of wisdom (Prov 1:7). The catalogue is complete: throat (v.13), tongue (v.13), lips (v.13), mouth (v.14), feet (v.15-17), eyes (v.18)

Rom.8.7 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. τὸ φρόνημα τῆς σαρκὸς ἐχθρὰ εἰς θεόν τῷ γὰρ νόμῳ τοῦ θεοῦ οὐχ ὑποτάσσεται οὐδὲ γὰρ δύναται; phronēma G5427; sarx G4561; echthra G2189; hypotassō G5293; dynamai G1410

Force. 'The mindset of the flesh is hostility toward God, for it does not submit to God's law, indeed it is not even able.' Phronēma is the mind-set or disposition of the sarx (flesh, the unregenerate condition). Echthra (active hostility) plus the two negations (ouch hypotassetai 'does not submit' and oude gar dynatai 'nor indeed is it able') push the verdict from observed non-submission to underlying structural incapacity. The faculty named is the will/disposition

Eph.2.1 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. καὶ ὑμᾶς ὄντας νεκροὺς τοῖς παραπτώμασιν καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις; nekros G3498; paraptōma G3900; hamartia G266

Force. 'And you, being dead in the trespasses and the sins.' Nekros is the ordinary Greek word for a corpse. Paul does not say 'sick' or 'wounded' but 'dead'. The dative tois paraptōmasin kai tais hamartiais marks the sphere of death: trespasses (deliberate slips) and sins (failures to hit the mark). Verses 4-5 frame the rescue as God making them alive together with Christ. The picture is resurrection, not rehabilitation

Eph.4.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐν ματαιότητι τοῦ νοῦς αὐτῶν; mataiotēs G3153; nous G3563

Force. 'In the futility of their mind.' Mataiotēs (emptiness, futility, vanity) governs the nous (mind, the seat of perception, judgment, and reason). Paul names the intellectual faculty as compromised, in continuity with the LXX use of mataiotēs in Ecclesiastes. The indictment is not of moral failure alone but of cognitive vanity

Eph.4.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐσκοτωμένοι τῇ διανοίᾳ ὄντες ἀπηλλοτριωμένοι τῆς ζωῆς τοῦ θεοῦ διὰ τὴν ἀγνοίαν τὴν οὖσαν ἐν αὐτοῖς διὰ τὴν πύρωσιν τῆς καρδίας αὐτῶν; skotoō G4656; dianoia G1271; apallotrioō G526; agnoia G52; pōrōsis G4457; kardia G2588

Force. 'Darkened in their understanding, alienated from the life of God, through the ignorance in them, through the hardness of their heart.' Four-layer indictment of inner faculties: dianoia (understanding) eskotōmenoi (darkened, perfect passive participle), apēllotriōmenoi (alienated, perfect passive participle) from the zōē tou theou (life of God), through agnoia (ignorance, not just lack of data) and pōrōsis (hardening, callousness, used medically of a callus forming over bone). The kardia (heart, the integrating center of the person) is the seat of the pōrōsis. Mind, understanding, knowledge, and heart are all named

Eph.4.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οἵτινες ἀπηλγηκότες ἑαυτοὺς παρέδωκαν τῇ ἀσελγείᾳ εἰς ἐργασίαν ἀκαθαρσίας πάσης; apalgeō G524; paradidōmi G3860; aselgeia G766; akatharsia G167

Force. 'Who, having become past feeling, have given themselves over to sensuality, to the working of every uncleanness.' Apalgeō (having grown numb, past feeling) names the affective faculty (the capacity for moral pain or shame) as deadened. Paradidōmi (they handed themselves over) is the self-surrender to aselgeia (unrestrained indulgence) and akatharsia (uncleanness). Affections and body are jointly named: feeling deadens, and the body is consigned to sensual practice

Jer.17.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key term. אִשָּׁה לֵבָבָהּ בִּקְעָה; leḅ H3820; aqob H6121; anush H605

Force. 'The heart is deceitful above all things and incurable, who can know it?' Leḅ is the comprehensive inner person (intellect, will, affections). Aqob (crooked, deceitful, treacherous, cognate of Jacob's name) is intensified by mikkol (above all things). Anush is the medical-grade word for a sickness past healing, used elsewhere of an incurable wound (Jer 15:18, 30:12). The heart is not merely tilted; it is medically beyond self-cure. The rhetorical question 'who can know it' presupposes that the heart is opaque even to its owner

Gen.6.5 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. כָּל חֲשַׁבְתּוֹת לֵבָבִי רָצִי לָרָע; yetzer H3336; machashebot H4284; leḅ H3820; raq H7535; ra H7451; kol H3605; yom H3117

Force. 'Every intention of the thoughts of his heart was only evil all the day.' Three superlatives stacked: kol (every) yetzer (intention, formation, inclination), of the machashebot (thoughts, devices), of the leḅ (heart); raq (only) ra (evil); kol hayyom (all the day). The construction excludes any neutral or good intent. Yetzer is the framing or fashioning, the deep inclination from which thoughts arise. Genesis frames this verse as God's appraisal that prompts the flood judgment

Gen.8.21 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. יָרַע לֵבָבִי מִנְעֻרִי; yetzer H3336; leḅ H3820; adam H120; ra H7451; neurim H5271

Force. 'For the intention of the heart of man is evil from his youth.' Post-flood reaffirmation. The flood removed the wicked of Noah's generation but did NOT remove the underlying yetzer of the leḅ of the adam. Min-neurim (from his youth) places the corruption developmentally early, not as the product of socialization or accumulated choices alone. Genesis bookends the flood (6:5 and 8:21) with the same diagnosis, signaling that judgment did not cure the human condition

Isa.64.6 · **for** · genre: prophecy · figures: simile

Key term. וְנִתְקַדַּשׁ לָכֵן מִיָּדַע דְּגִבְכּוֹ וְנִלְכֵּךְ אִמְטָכָא יְהִנּוּ; tame H2931; beged H899; ed H5708; tzidqot H6666; nabel H5034

Force. 'We have all become as the unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as a polluted garment.' Tame (ritually unclean), beged (garment), ed (commonly understood as a menstrual cloth, ritual impurity at peak). Tzidqot is the plural of tzedakah (righteous acts, the best deeds of religious people). The indictment targets the very category of best human moral effort, not the obvious failures. The next verb nabel (we fade, wither) like a leaf governs the human collectively. Even religious righteousness is unclean

John.3.6 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key term. τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τῆς σαρκὸς σὰρξ ἐστὶν καὶ τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τοῦ πνεύματος πνεῦμά ἐστιν; gennaō G1080; sarx G4561; pneuma G4151

Force. 'What is born of the flesh is flesh, and what is born of the Spirit is spirit.' Jesus to Nicodemus. Natural generation (ek tēs sarkos) produces only sarx (flesh, the unregenerate condition); only the Spirit can produce pneuma (spiritual life). The categorical distinction excludes the natural production of spiritual life, supporting the proposition that fallen humans cannot of themselves produce the saving good of pneuma life

John.6.44 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδεὶς δύναται ἔλθειν πρὸς με ἢ ὁ πατήρ ὁ πέμψας με ἑλκύσῃ αὐτόν; oudeis G3762; dynamai G1410; helkyō G1670

Force. 'No one is able to come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him.' Oudeis (no one) negates dynamai (be able) categorically. Helkyō (drag, draw, used elsewhere of dragging a net or a sword) is strong, not gentle persuasion. The condition (ean mē) makes the Father's drawing the necessary prior cause of any coming. The verse is a direct lexical statement of post-fall inability to come to Christ apart from prior divine action

Gen.9.6 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key term. וְהָשַׁע מִיְהוָה תָּא רָדָא; tselem H6754; elohim H430; adam H120

Force. 'For in the image of God he made man.' Post-flood reaffirmation of the imago Dei as the ground for the prohibition of murder. Complicates a maximal reading of total destruction of the image: even after the fall and the flood, humans bear God's image (tselem) in some sense that grounds the sanctity of human life. The harmonizing reading: every faculty is affected and corrupted, but the image is damaged, darkened, marred, not annihilated. The Reformed confessions (Westminster 4.2, Heidelberg) preserve this by speaking of the image lost in its moral excellencies but retained in the structural ontology of personhood

Acts.17.30 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key term. παραγγέλλει τοῖς ἀνθρώποις πάντας πανταχοῦ μετανοεῖν; paraggellō G3853; metanoēō G3340

Force. 'God commands all people everywhere to repent.' Universal command (pantas pantachou) to metanoēō (change of mind). Complicating: if fallen humans cannot of themselves come to God, why command repentance universally. Standard harmonization: the command measures obligation, not native capacity; the inability is moral (rooted in unwillingness), not metaphysical compulsion; the command also functions as the means through which God grants repentance to those he draws (2 Tim 2:25)

Concordance lemmas traversed

G1342, G3761, G1520, G5028, G455, G2995, G1100, G1387, G2447, G785, G5401, G3788, G5427, G4561, G2189, G5293, G1410, G3498, G3900, G266, G3153, G3563, G4656, G1271, G526, G52, G4457, G2588, G524, G3860, G766, G167, G1080, G4151, G3762, G1670, G3853, G3340, H3820, H6121, H605, H3336, H4284, H7535, H7451, H3605, H3117, H120, H5271, H2931, H899, H5708, H6666, H5034, H6754, H430

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Augustine, Anti-Pelagian writings, On Nature and Grace; Council of Carthage AD 418; Second Council of Orange AD 529 · affirms · unverified

“Augustine defended that the will after the fall is bound and cannot do spiritual good without prevenient grace. Carthage 418 condemned Pelagius, Orange 529 condemned semi-Pelagianism affirming grace must precede every salutary movement of the will.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church 405-407 · complicates · verified

“Human nature is 'wounded in the natural powers proper to it, subject to ignorance, suffering and the dominion of death, and inclined to sin', but rejects the Protestant claim that the fall destroys human freedom entirely. Wounded, not destroyed.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Articles II and XVIII; Formula of Concord I (Original Sin) and II (Free Will); Luther, Bondage of the Will · affirms · unverified

“All who are propagated according to nature are born with sin, that is, without the fear of God, without trust in God, and with concupiscence. The will has no power, without the Holy Ghost, to work the righteousness of God.”

anglican · Articles of Religion (1571), Article 9 (Of Original or Birth-Sin) and Article 10 (Of Free Will) · affirms · unverified

“Original sin is the fault and corruption of the nature of every man, whereby man is very far gone from original righteousness, and of his own nature inclined to evil. We have no power to do good works without the grace of God by Christ preventing us.”

reformed · Canons of Dort 3/4.1-4; Westminster Confession 6.4 and 9.3; Heidelberg Catechism Q8; Belgic Confession Art. 14 · affirms · unverified

“Man, fallen from his original integrity, is wholly defiled in all parts and faculties of soul and body; wholly incapable of any saving good without regenerating grace, and that grace is effectual.”

methodist · Articles of Religion of the Methodist Church, Article VII (Original Sin) and Article VIII (Free Will) · affirms · verified

“Original sin is the corruption of the nature of every man, naturally engendered of the offspring of Adam. He cannot turn and prepare himself, by his own natural strength and works, to faith and calling upon God, without grace.”

anabaptist · Mennonite Dordrecht Confession of Faith 1632, Article II on the Fall of Man · affirms · unverified

“By disobedience man fell from the grace of God, became corrupt, and was separated from God, unable to draw nigh unto God except through the promise of grace in Christ.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Articles 3-5 (Fall and Salvation) · affirms · unverified

“Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ. The fall left humanity in need of salvation that only Christ can provide; prevenient grace makes free response possible.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America teaching on sin and the fall · complicates · verified

“Man still remains the created image of God; this cannot be changed, but he fails to keep his image pure and to retain the divine likeness. Image darkened, not erased. Rejects total depravity in the Augustinian-Reformed sense; synergism.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/3-10.htm>

“ouk estin dikaios G1342 oude G3761 heis G1520. Universal negation: 'there is none righteous, not even one' opens the catena indicting all humanity under sin.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/3-13.htm>

“taphos G5028 'grave' aneōgmenos 'opened'; larynx G2995 'throat'; glōssa G1100 'tongue'; dolioō G1387 'use deceit'; ios G2447 aspidōn G785 'venom of asps'.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/2-1.htm>

“nekrous G3498 'dead, lifeless, a corpse'; paraptōmasin G3900 'trespasses'; hamartiais G266 'sins'. Natural state described as death, not weakness.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/4-17.htm>

“mataiotēs G3153 'futility, emptiness' governs nous G3563 'mind'. The cognitive faculty itself named under indictment.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/4-18.htm>

“eskotōmenoi G4656 'darkened'; apēllotriōmenoi G526 'alienated'; agnoia G52 'ignorance'; pōrōsis G4457 'hardening, callousness'. Four-layer indictment of inner faculties.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/jeremiah/17-9.htm>

“leb H3820 'heart'; aqob H6121 'deceitful, crooked'; anush H605 'incurable, desperately sick'. The heart medically beyond self-cure.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/6-5.htm>

“yetzer H3336 'intention, inclination'; machashebot H4284 'thoughts'; leb H3820 'heart'; raq H7535 ra H7451 kol H3605 hayyom 'only evil all the day'.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/8-21.htm>

“yetzer H3336 leb H3820 ha-adam H120 ra H7451 minneurav H5271 'the intention of the heart of man is evil from his youth'. Post-flood reaffirmation.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/isaiah/64-6.htm>

“tame H2931 'unclean'; beged H899 'garment'; ed H5708 'polluted/menstrual cloth'; tzidqot H6666 'righteousnesses'. Even best deeds described as polluted garment.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/6-44.htm>

“oudeis G3762 dynatai G1410 elthein 'no one is able to come' unless ho patēr heklysē G1670 (draws, drags) auton. Categorical post-fall inability.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8-7.htm>

“phronēma G5427 tēs sarkos G4561; echthra G2189 'hostility'; ouch hypotassetai G5293 'does not submit'; oude gar dynatai G1410 'nor is it even able'.”

complicates · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P1C.HTM

“CCC 405: human nature is wounded in the natural powers proper to it, subject to ignorance, suffering and the dominion of death, and inclined to sin. Rejects Protestant claim that the fall destroys human freedom entirely.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article VII: original sin is the corruption of the nature of every man, naturally engendered of the offspring of Adam. Article VIII: he cannot turn and prepare himself without grace.”

complicates · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/doctrine-scripture>

“Man still remains the created image of God; this cannot be changed, but he fails to keep his image pure and to retain the divine likeness. Image darkened, not erased; synergism affirmed.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence